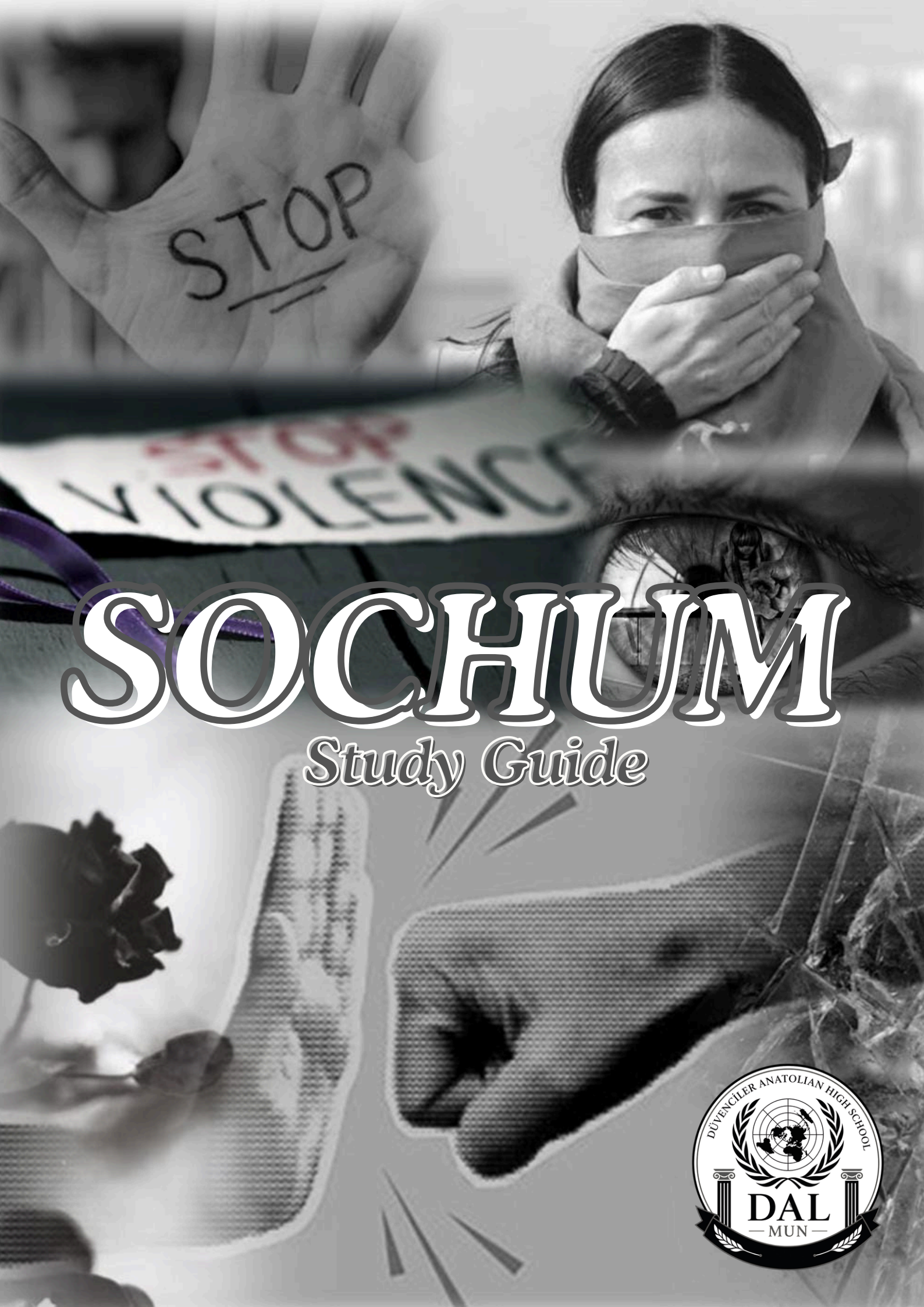


SOCHUM

Study Guide

DÜVENCİLER ANATOLIAN HIGH SCHOOL
DAL
MUN

Agenda Item: *addressing* gender-based violence and promoting gender equality.

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1- LETTER FROM THE HEAD of ACADEMY

Dear Esteemed Delegates,

First of all, I would like to say that I am honored to welcome you all to DALMUN'26. As the Head of Academy, my team and I look forward to hearing about the bright ideas and creative solutions that you will bring to this conference, and especially to this committee. As delegates of the SOCHUM committee, each and every one of you has the responsibility to address global challenges, exchange ideas, and work towards creating effective and sustainable solutions. You have the opportunity to step into the shoes of the leaders who make important decisions around the world. Throughout this committee, you will be expected to approach complex issues from different perspectives while working towards meaningful solutions.

Gender-based violence remains a serious global issue that affects individuals and communities across the world. Despite significant progress in raising awareness and promoting equality, many people continue to face discrimination, violence and barriers to equal opportunities. Addressing these challenges requires not only effective national policies but also international cooperation, education and awareness.

I encourage each of you to research your country's position thoroughly, understand the existing international frameworks concerning gender equality and the prevention of gender-based violence, and consider both the challenges and opportunities presented by different approaches. As you develop your solutions, remember the importance of protecting human rights, ensuring equal opportunities, supporting vulnerable communities, and addressing the social and structural factors that contribute to inequality. Most importantly, remember that Model United Nations is not simply about defending a position; it is about diplomacy, cooperation, and finding common ground.

On behalf of the academy, I wish you all an engaging, productive, and memorable committee. I look forward to witnessing the diplomacy, creativity and leadership you bring to the floor.

Best regards,
Dila Asya TOPÇU
Head of Academy

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2- LETTER FROM THE UNDER SECRETARY GENERAL of SOCHUM

Distinguished delegates of DALMUN'26,

It is my pleasure to welcome you all to our conference. I am Ekin, your under secretary general, and i will be accompanying you throughout this unforgettable journey at DALMUN'26. As delegates of the Social, Humanitarian and Cultural committee (SOCHUM), you will have the opportunity to discuss some of the most pressing humanitarian and social issues facing our world today. From the protection of human rights to the empowerment of vulnerable communities, your debates will challenge you to think critically, defend your nations' policies and work together towards meaningful solutions. Sochum is not only about discussing global issues; it is also about understanding different perspectives, listening to one another, and recognizing the importance of international cooperation. I encourage each of you to participate actively, challenge yourselves, and approach every topic with an open mind and willingness to collaborate. Beyond the academic experience, I hope this conference becomes a place where you build confidence, friendships, and memories that will stay with you long after the final gavel. I sincerely believe that DALMUN'26 will leave a lasting impact on all of us, both academically and personally.

I look forward to meeting each and every one of you.

See you at DALMUN'26.

Ekin Uslu
Under Secretary General of SOCHUM

3- INTRODUCTION TO THE COMMITTE

a) What is SOCHUM?

SOCHUM, which stands for the Social, Humanitarian, and Cultural Committee, is formally recognized as the Third Committee of the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA). It is a vital organ composed of all 193 UN member states, dedicated entirely to discussing issues that intersect with human rights, social advancement, and cultural preservation. Deeply rooted in the foundational principles of the 1948 Universal Declaration of Human Rights, SOCHUM is tasked with addressing the world's most pressing humanitarian crises, protecting vulnerable populations, and advancing global social justice. Unlike bodies like the Security Council, SOCHUM does not have the power to enforce military action or economic sanctions; instead, it wields immense normative influence by crafting comprehensive resolutions, setting global standards, and holding member states accountable to international human rights expectations.

When tackling the specific agenda item, "Addressing Gender-Based Violence and Promoting Gender Equality," SOCHUM functions as the premier international battleground against systemic misogyny, domestic abuse, and institutional discrimination. Because gender inequality is not just a legal issue but a deeply entrenched social and cultural phenomenon, it falls squarely within SOCHUM's unique mandate. Within this committee, delegates are expected to analyze how intersecting factors—such as poverty, armed conflict, lack of education, and harmful traditional practices—disproportionately expose women, girls, and marginalized genders to violence and economic disenfranchisement.

Discussions under this agenda item in SOCHUM go far beyond merely acknowledging the problem. Delegates must engage in rigorous diplomatic negotiation to draft actionable resolutions that achieve several critical objectives:

- **Strengthening Legal Frameworks:** Urging member states to criminalize all forms of domestic, digital, and structural gender-based violence (GBV) while ending legal impunity for perpetrators.
- **Socio-Economic Empowerment:** Creating global strategies that guarantee equal pay, female representation in political leadership, and unrestricted access to healthcare and quality education.
- **Cultural and Institutional Reform:** Promoting grassroots awareness campaigns to dismantle patriarchal norms and reform discriminatory social institutions from the ground up.

Ultimately, SOCHUM serves as a collective global conscience. Through the debate of this agenda item, the committee aims to transform the abstract ideals of gender equality into concrete, international frameworks that empower member states to build safer, more equitable, and just societies for everyone.

4- INTRODUCTION TO THE AGENDA ITEM

a) Understanding the Agenda: Key Terms and Definitions

To conduct a structured, legally sound, and productive debate within SOCHUM, delegates must operate under a synchronized vocabulary. The following comprehensive definitions outline the legal, social, and operational frameworks necessary to address systemic inequalities and violence.

Fundamental Gender Concepts

1. ***Gender vs. Sex:*** A foundational distinction in international law. Sex refers strictly to the biological, anatomical, and physiological characteristics that define male, female, or intersex individuals.

Gender, conversely, refers to the socially constructed roles, behaviors, expressions, expectations, and identities that a given society attributes to individuals. SOCHUM focuses on gender because these societal constructs are fluid, learned, and frequently used to justify systemic power imbalances.

2. G***ender Equality:*** The ultimate human rights objective wherein all individuals, regardless of their gender identity or biological sex, possess equal rights, responsibilities, visibility, and opportunities. It implies that the systemic value placed on individuals and their access to societal resources must not depend on the sex they were assigned at birth.

3. G***ender Equity:*** The operational pathway toward achieving equality. Equity recognizes that different genders have distinct needs, realities, and historical disadvantages. Therefore, it involves fairness of treatment, which may include identical treatment or treatment that is different but considered equivalent in terms of rights, benefits, obligations, and opportunities. Equal treatment in an unequal system does not yield fairness; equity balances the scale first.

4. ***Intersectionality:*** The term was first coined by Kimberlé Crenshaw in 1989. In her article titled "Demarginalizing the Intersection of Race and Sex: A Black Feminist Critique of Antidiscrimination Doctrine, Feminist Theory and Antiracist Politics," Crenshaw used the term "intersectionality" to help explain the oppression of African American women. Intersectionality is an analytical framework used to understand how an individual's social and political identities interact to create distinct forms of discrimination and privilege in society. Intersectionality identifies multiple factors of advantage and disadvantage. Examples of these factors include gender, race, ethnicity, class, sexual orientation, religion, disability, and physical appearance. These intersecting and overlapping social identities can be both empowering and oppressive.

Typologies of Gender-Based Violence (GBV)

1. ***Gender-Based Violence (GBV):***Gender-based violence against women is defined as violence directed at a woman simply because she is a woman, or violence that disproportionately affects women. Violence against women involves the intimidation of women through the use of physical force or threats, and encompasses a wide range of harmful behaviors directed at women and girls due to their gender.

2. ***Intimate Partner Violence (IPV) / Domestic Abuse:*** Intimate partner violence and domestic abuse encompass any form of coercion, harm, or mistreatment inflicted by one individual upon another—whether in an intimate relationship or while living under the same roof—with the aim of controlling, frightening, intimidating, or asserting dominance over the other. This phenomenon manifests not only physically but also across emotional, sexual, economic, and digital dimensions.

3. ***Structural Violence:*** Structural violence is a form of violence in which certain social structures or institutions harm people by preventing them from meeting their basic needs or exercising their rights.

4. ***Institutional Violence:*** Institutional violence is a set of systemic policies, practices, and beliefs employed by state institutions, corporations, or large organizations to exclude, exploit, or control vulnerable groups. Rather than physical force, it refers to the psychological, economic, or social pressure exerted on individuals through rules, laws, and organizational culture.

5. ***Harmful Practices:*** Cultural, traditional, or religious practices that directly violate universal human rights standards and inflict long-term physical or psychological trauma. Within SOCHUM, the debate centers heavily on eradicating two prominent forms: Child, Early, and Forced Marriage (CEFM) and Female Genital Mutilation/Cutting (FGM/C).

6. ***Digital or Cyber Gender-Based Violence:*** Digital or cyber gender-based violence is a human rights violation in which individuals are targeted, intimidated, manipulated, or abused via digital tools and online platforms based on their gender, gender identity, or sexual orientation. It is a reflection of offline inequalities and power dynamics in the virtual environment.

Frameworks for Policy and Action

1. ***Gender-Responsive Approach:*** A methodology that goes beyond merely acknowledging gender differences to actively planning, implementing, and evaluating international policies and humanitarian relief in a way that targets the specific vulnerabilities, needs, and priorities of all genders.

2. ***Vulnerability-Amplified Zones:*** Specific, high-risk environments—such as active conflict sectors, post-conflict zones, refugee camps, and climate-induced disaster regions—where the collapse of legal infrastructure and law enforcement exponentially increases the prevalence of human trafficking, forced marriages, and the deployment of sexual violence as a weapon of war.

3. ***Gender Mainstreaming:*** The globally agreed strategy (established at the 1995 Beijing World Conference on Women) for promoting gender equality. It involves integration of a gender perspective into the preparation, design, implementation, monitoring, and evaluation of policies, regulatory measures, and spending programmes, with a view to promoting equality and combating discrimination.

5- BACKGROUND of THE AGENDA ITEM

a) Historical Context of Gender Inequality

Gender inequality is not a contemporary aberration but the product of centuries of deeply entrenched, systemic patriarchal structures.

Historically, legal, political, and economic frameworks worldwide were constructed around the male figure as the default citizen and head of household, effectively relegating women to the private sphere. This historic disenfranchisement manifested in the denial of fundamental rights, such as voting, property ownership, and independent financial agency, across most civilizations well into the 20th century.

Within the framework of the United Nations, the recognition of these historical injustices led to pivotal milestones that SOCHUM delegates must reference. The adoption of the Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination against Women (CEDAW) in 1979 established a landmark international bill of rights for women. This was later reinforced by the 1995 Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action, which remains the most comprehensive global visionary blueprint for achieving gender equality. Despite these historic treaties, the legacy of past discrimination continues to perpetuate modern disparities in power, institutional representation, and societal valuation.

b) Forms of Gender-Based Violence (GBV)

Gender-Based Violence (GBV) is a global pandemic that crosses all social, economic, and national boundaries, serving as both a cause and a consequence of gender inequality. SOCHUM classifies GBV not as isolated criminal acts, but as a systemic human rights violation designed to enforce subordination.

i. Physical and Domestic Violence

Physical and domestic violence encompasses acts of bodily harm, sexual assault, and intimate partner violence occurring within the private sphere. This remains one of the most underreported forms of violence due to deep-seated cultural stigmas and the historical mischaracterization of domestic abuse as a "private family matter.".

The lack of robust domestic legal frameworks or police training in many member states leaves survivors without adequate protection, legal recourse, or safe shelters, perpetuating a cycle of impunity for perpetrators.

ii. Psychological and Economic Abuse

Often invisible but deeply debilitating, psychological abuse involves coercive control, gaslighting, systemic isolation, and verbal degradation aimed at dismantling a victim's autonomy and mental well-being. This is frequently coupled with economic abuse, where perpetrators restrict a victim's access to financial resources, forbid them from seeking employment, or control their earned income. By inducing total financial and emotional dependency, economic and psychological abuse effectively traps survivors, stripping them of the agency required to leave abusive environments.

iii. Cyber GBV / Online Harassment

The rapid proliferation of digital technologies has given rise to Cyber GBV, a borderless threat that disproportionately targets women, girls, and human rights defenders. This includes the non-consensual sharing of intimate images, doxxing, cyberstalking, and organized online hate campaigns. Because digital harassment bypasses physical borders, member states face immense challenges in jurisdiction, digital policing, and content regulation, making cyber GBV a critical and evolving priority for modern international human rights forums.

iv. Child, Early, and Forced Marriages (CEFM)

Child, Early, and Forced Marriage (CEFM) is a severe violation of a child's right to education, health, and physical integrity. Driven by poverty, lack of educational infrastructure, and patriarchal traditions, CEFM disproportionately forces young girls out of school and into premature adult responsibilities. This practice drastically increases the risk of early pregnancy —which often leads to severe maternal mortality rates—and locks young girls into lifelong socio-economic vulnerability.

v. Harmful Traditional Practices

Harmful traditional practices represent violence justified under the guise of culture, tradition, or religion. This sub-category includes Female Genital Mutilation (FGM), honor killings, and dowry-related violence. SOCHUM maintains a strict stance that cultural relativism can never be invoked to justify the violation of basic human rights, and member states are continually urged to bridge the gap between international human rights standards and local customary laws.

c) The Socio-Economic Impact of Inequality

The ramifications of gender inequality extend far beyond social injustice; they inflict profound damage on global macroeconomic development and public infrastructure. When women and girls are denied equal access to quality education, global economies lose half of their potential human capital, capping productivity and innovation. Furthermore, the pervasive "glass ceiling" and the gender pay gap prevent women from occupying leadership roles, stalling progress in both corporate and public sectors.

A critical component of this economic disparity is the unequal distribution of unpaid care work. Globally, women perform the vast majority of unpaid domestic tasks, including childcare, eldercare, and household maintenance. This invisible labor force acts as a subsidy to the global economy but severely limits women's ability to participate in formal, paid employment or pursue higher education. Addressing these gaps is fundamental to fulfilling the UN's Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), specifically SDG 5 (Gender Equality) and SDG 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth).

d) Concept of Intersectionality

To effectively address these crises, SOCHUM delegates must utilize the analytical framework of intersectionality—a term coined by legal scholar Kimberlé Crenshaw.

Intersectionality asserts that individuals do not experience discrimination in a vacuum; rather, gender inequality intersects with other forms of oppression, such as race, ethnicity, socioeconomic class, age, disability, geographic location, and migratory status. A singular focus on "women" as a homogenous group fails to account for the unique vulnerabilities faced by marginalized populations.

For example, a displaced or refugee woman faces compound institutional barriers that a wealthy, native-born woman in a developed country does not. Similarly, indigenous women or women with disabilities experience significantly higher rates of GBV and encounter greater obstacles when trying to access legal justice or healthcare systems. For SOCHUM to draft effective resolutions, delegates must avoid "one-size-fits-all" approaches and instead design intersectional policies that actively accommodate and protect the most vulnerable sub-demographics of society.

6- RISKS and CURRENT CHALLANGES

a) Lack of Reporting and Social Stigma

Underreporting and social stigma remain among the most critical obstacles in effectively addressing gender-based violence (GBV) and protecting human rights globally. Stigma operates as a powerful mechanism of social control, often shifting the burden of blame from perpetrators to victims. Fear of public shaming, social ostracization, and family dishonor forces many survivors into silence, leaving severe human rights violations unaddressed within communities.

This pervasive silence is further exacerbated by systemic distrust in law enforcement and legal frameworks. In many jurisdictions, inadequate victim-protection mechanisms, legislative loopholes, and a lack of gender-sensitive judicial training deter individuals from seeking justice.

Survivors frequently anticipate secondary victimization—including insensitive questioning, breach of confidentiality, and procedural delays—when interacting with formal reporting channels. Furthermore, economic dependence on perpetrators and the absence of accessible shelter networks or psychological support leave survivors with limited alternatives to escaping abusive environments.

Consequently, the convergence of institutional barriers, socioeconomic constraints, and societal backlash fosters a climate of impunity. This systemic underreporting distorts national and international data, masking the true extent of gender-based violence and hindering the development of targeted, evidence-based policy interventions—particularly in conflict-affected or crisis-driven regions where support systems are further compromised.

b) Weak Legal Frameworks and Impunity

A major impediment to eradicating gender-based violence (GBV) is the presence of inadequate legal frameworks and the widespread impunity enjoyed by perpetrators. In various legal systems globally, existing laws fail to explicitly criminalize all forms of violence, including marital rape, domestic abuse, and digital harassment. Furthermore, legislative ambiguity, outdated statutory definitions, and conflicting customary or religious practices often dilute formal legal protections, leaving survivors without effective recourse

Even where comprehensive legislation exists, the enforcement gap remains substantial due to weak institutional capacity and systemic corruption. Law enforcement and judicial institutions frequently suffer from underfunding, insufficient training on gender sensitivity, and prolonged trial procedures. These structural flaws result in exceptionally low conviction rates, which reinforce a public perception that judicial systems are indifferent to survivors. By failing to hold perpetrators accountable, state institutions inadvertently sustain a cycle of violence, undermining rule of law and signaling that human rights violations against marginalized groups carry little to no consequence.

c) Vulnerability in Conflict Zones and Crises

Armed conflicts, political instability, and humanitarian crises drastically exacerbate pre-existing gender inequalities, exposing women, girls, and marginalized populations to heightened levels of violence. During times of war or crisis, formal state structures, judicial systems, and law enforcement mechanisms often collapse or become severely impaired. This breakdown of public infrastructure leaves civilian populations without baseline legal protection, enabling armed groups, military forces, and opportunists to commit human rights abuses with widespread impunity. In many conflict settings, sexual and gender-based violence is systematically utilized as a tactic of warfare to terrorize communities, assert control, and force mass displacement.

Furthermore, forced displacement and emergency settings place refugees, internally displaced persons (IDPs), and asylum seekers in inherently precarious living conditions. Overcrowded refugee camps, informal settlements, and temporary shelters frequently lack essential security infrastructure, such as adequate lighting, private sanitation facilities, and safe community spaces. In these environments, economic devastation and the loss of traditional community support networks force many individuals into dangerous survival strategies, increasing their susceptibility to human trafficking, forced labor, exploitation, and child marriage.

The situation is further compounded by the severe disruption of essential services, including emergency healthcare, psychological assistance, and legal aid. Humanitarian organizations attempting to operate in crisis settings face physical danger, restricted access, and chronic underfunding, which significantly restricts their ability to provide life-saving interventions. Consequently, survivors in conflict zones face a dual crisis: an escalated threat of physical and sexual violence paired with a complete absence of the medical, psychological, and judicial resources necessary for recovery and justice.

d) The “Shadow Pandemic”

The term “Shadow Pandemic” refers to the sharp and alarming increase in violence against women and girls that occurs alongside global public health emergencies, economic crises, and natural disasters. While public and institutional attention naturally shifts toward immediate crisis response, underlying social vulnerabilities are severely magnified. Emergency measures such as lockdowns, movement restrictions, and quarantine protocols, while necessary for public safety, effectively trap survivors indoors with their abusers, creating ideal conditions for domestic and intimate partner violence to escalate behind closed doors.

This crisis within a crisis is further worsened by the widespread disruption of essential social support systems and legal protections. During widespread emergencies, resources and personnel from healthcare, social work, and law enforcement are frequently diverted toward primary crisis management. As a result, helplines, emergency shelters, and legal aid clinics experience significant operational capacity reductions or total shutdowns. The simultaneous restriction of physical movement and reduced access to digital communication tools prevent survivors from seeking emergency assistance or escaping abusive households.

Ultimately, the Shadow Pandemic demonstrates that disaster response mechanisms often fail to incorporate gender-sensitive frameworks, leaving structural protection gaps during times of emergency. The compounded economic stress, job loss, and heightened psychological frustration during crises act as catalysts for perpetrator aggression, while leaving survivors with fewer economic means to leave. Addressing this phenomenon requires integrating gender-responsive policies into national emergency preparedness plans, ensuring that essential support services remain operational and accessible regardless of the crisis context.

e) Economic Disparities and Wage Gap

Economic inequality and the gender wage gap represent pervasive structural barriers that limit women's autonomy, development, and overall well-being globally. Worldwide, women consistently earn less than men for work of equal value and remain heavily overrepresented in low-paying, informal, and precarious employment sectors that lack labor protections and social security benefits. This persistent financial disparity is further compounded by the disproportionate burden of unpaid care and domestic work placed on women, which severely restricts their full participation in the formal workforce, higher education, and leadership roles.

The economic marginalization of women directly increases their vulnerability to systemic exploitation, poverty, and gender-based violence. Financial dependence on male family members or domestic partners often strips survivors of the financial means necessary to leave abusive relationships, secure independent housing, or access legal and medical aid. Furthermore, discriminatory practices regarding property ownership, inheritance laws, and access to financial credit continue to deny women economic self-sufficiency, entrenching generational cycles of poverty and economic vulnerability.

Addressing these economic disparities is essential not only for achieving gender equality but also for fostering broader global economic resilience and sustainable development. When women lack equal access to financial resources and equal pay, entire economies suffer from lost productivity and underutilized human capital. Institutional reforms that enforce equal pay legislation, expand affordable childcare, promote financial inclusion, and protect informal workers are crucial steps toward closing the economic gender gap and ensuring long-term systemic stability

7) International Legal Framework

a) Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR)

The **Universal Declaration of Human Rights** (**UDHR**) is a document adopted by the United Nations General Assembly that codifies some of the rights and freedoms of all human beings. Drafted by a United Nations (UN) committee chaired by Eleanor Roosevelt, it was accepted by the General Assembly as resolution 217 during its third session on 10 December 1948 at the Palais de Challiot in Paris, France. Of the 58 members of the UN at the time, 48 voted in favour, none against, eight abstained, and two did not vote.

A foundational text in the history of human and civil rights, the Declaration consists of 30 articles detailing an individual's "basic rights and fundamental freedoms" and affirming their universal character as inherent, inalienable, and applicable to all human beings. Adopted as a "common standard of achievement for all peoples and all nations", the UDHR commits nations to recognize all humans as being "born free and equal in dignity and rights" regardless of "nationality, place of residence, sex, national or ethnic origin, colour, religion, language, or any other status".

The Declaration is generally considered to be a milestone document for its universalist language, which makes no reference to a particular culture, political system, or religion. It directly inspired the development of international human rights law, and was the first step in the formulation of the International Bill of Human Rights, which was completed in 1966 and came into force in 1976. Although not legally binding, the contents of the UDHR have been elaborated and incorporated into subsequent international treaties, regional human rights instruments, and national constitutions and legal codes.

All 193 member states of the UN have ratified at least one of the nine binding treaties influenced by the Declaration, with the vast majority ratifying four or more. While there is a wide consensus that the declaration itself is non-binding and not part of customary international law, there is also a consensus in most countries that many of its provisions are part of customary law, although courts in some nations have been more restrictive in interpreting its legal effect. Nevertheless, the UDHR has influenced legal, political, and social developments on both the global and national levels, with its significance partly evidenced by its 577 translations.

b) International Convention on Women's Rights (CEDAW)

The **Convention on the Elimination of all Forms of Discrimination Against Women** (**CEDAW**) is an international treaty adopted in 1979 by the United Nations General Assembly. Described as an international bill of rights for women, it was instituted on 3 September 1981 and has been ratified by 189 states. Over fifty countries that have ratified the convention have done so subject to certain declarations, reservations, and objections, including 38 countries who rejected the enforcement article 29, which addresses means of settlement for disputes concerning the interpretation or application of the convention. Australia's declaration noted the limitations on central government power resulting from its federal constitutional system. The United States and Palau have signed, but not ratified the treaty. The Holy See, Iran, Somalia, Sudan, and Tonga are not signatories to CEDAW.

c) Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action

Considered the most progressive blueprint ever for advancing women's rights, the Beijing Declaration and Platform for Action has been reprinted in this special edition, which also includes a copy of the political declaration reached at the 23rd special session of the General Assembly in 2000, which reviewed progress towards the Platform for Action five years after its adoption.

d) UN Sustainable Development Goal 5 (SDG 5)

Sustainable Development Goal 5 (SDG 5 or Global Goal 5) concerns gender equality and is fifth of the 17 Sustainable Development Goals established by United Nations in 2015. Through the pledge to "Leave No One Behind", countries have committed to fast-track progress for those furthest behind first. SDG 5 aims to grant women and girls equal rights and opportunities to live free of violence and discrimination, including in the workplace.

The Sustainable Development Goals are a collection of 17 global goals set by the United Nations. The broad goals are thematically linked, yet each has its own specific targets to achieve. The SDGs cover a broad range of social and economic development issues, including poverty, hunger, health, education, climate change, gender equality, water supply, sanitation, energy, urbanization, environment and social justice.

8) Landmark Treaties and Cases

a) The Istanbul Convention

The Council of Europe Convention on preventing and combating violence against women and domestic violence, also known as "the Istanbul Convention", is based on the understanding that violence against women is a form of gender-based violence that is committed against women because they are women. It is the obligation of the state to address it fully in all its forms and to take measures to prevent violence against women, protect its victims and prosecute the perpetrators. Failure to do so would make it the responsibility of the state. The convention leaves no doubt: there can be no real equality between women and men if women experience gender-based violence on a large-scale and state agencies and institutions turn a blind eye.

b) UN Resolution 1325

The Security Council adopted resolution (S/RES/1325) on women and peace and security on 31 October 2000. The resolution reaffirms the important role of women in the prevention and resolution of conflicts, peace negotiations, peace-building, peacekeeping, humanitarian response and in post-conflict reconstruction and stresses the importance of their equal participation and full involvement in all efforts for the maintenance and promotion of peace and security. Resolution 1325 urges all actors to increase the participation of women and incorporate gender perspectives in all United Nations peace and security efforts. It also calls on all parties to conflict to take special measures to protect women and girls from gender-based violence, particularly rape and other forms of sexual abuse, in situations of armed conflict. The resolution provides a number of important operational mandates, with implications for Member States and the entities of the United Nations system

9- QUESTIONS a RESOLUTION SHOULD ADDRESS

1.How can Member States create safe and confidential reporting systems so that survivors of violence feel safe to seek help?

2.What simple financial programs (such as job training or emergency housing support) can help survivors become financially independent?

3.How can international organizations better protect women and girls during conflicts, natural disasters, and health crises?

4.What action can be taken to stop online harassment, cyber-bullying, and digital gender-based violence on social media platforms?

5.What measures can Member States introduce to reduce the gender pay gap and promote equal economic opportunities for women?

6.What measures can Member States take to prevent and eliminate child, early and forced marriage and address its root causes?

7.What steps need to be taken to eradicate the worst forms of traditional practices which are perceived to be discriminatory to women and girl children, such as female genital mutilation (FGM), honor killings and dowry related violence?

8.How can governments and communities around the world reduce social stigma, victim blaming and reporting of gender-based violence?

9.How can Member States guarantee equal opportunities for education and for work for women and girls?

10. How should the international community tackle 'harmful practices' where protecting human rights is in conflict with cultural and national sovereignty issues?

11. How can stronger laws on gender-based violence pass into effect when, in many countries, prevailing social norms and institutions condone such violence against women?

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